

TIPS FOR SAVING MONEY NOW

Scaled back on lattes and lunches but still searching for extra cash? You can locate the best deals on everything from T-shirts to appliances when you compare prices at websites like www.smartbargains.com and www.pricegrabber.com. You'll find coupons for some of your favorite stores at www.retailmenot.com and www.dealsofamerica.com, and discount certificates for eating out at www.restaurant.com. There's a massive selection of off-price merchandise at www.overstock.com. And for a steady stream of money-saving tips, try blogs like www.getrichslowly.org, www.myopenwallet.net, and www.zenhabs.net.

↓ **KEEPING TRACK OF MONEY COMING IN AND GOING OUT**

When your parents were your age, keeping tabs on their money was pretty easy. They had a checkbook and added up the money going in and subtracted each expense coming out. Today, it's trickier because we have so many different accounts and means of accessing money. Here are some ways to help you organize your payments and track your spending. It doesn't matter which system you use—the point is to choose one that speaks to you so you'll stick with it.

- **Use your bank's online bill-paying system.** Most banks provide a free way to pay certain merchants electronically. Here's how it works: You have to list the merchants you pay regularly (power company, landlord, the gym), along with the amount you want to pay each of them and the dates on which you want the bank to send a payment. The bank then debits money from your account and deposits it into the merchant's account, or it will send a bank cashier's check (this could take up to five days to arrive). You can authorize